structural level, changes in India's security environment brought about by a more powerful and aggressive China and its growing strategic convergence with Pakistan have been leading to a rethink on non-alignment as a guiding principle of India's foreign policy; related to this is a growing conviction that India's developmental priorities cannot be met without substantive cooperation with the United States. At the domestic level, Prime Minister Modi enjoys a strong position within his own party and in the Indian Parliament; and, last, the political authority and world outlook of the Prime Minister himself are influencing factors.

The origins of non-alignment in India

The Indian political landscape has been altered radically with Narendra Modi and his Bharatiya Janata Party coming to power in 2014. In a move of great symbolism, Modi did not attend the 17th Non-Aligned Movement (NAM) summit despite Venezuela's repeated attempts to woo him and instead dispatched Vice President Hamid Ansari. Modi was only the second Prime Minister to miss the summit, following Charan Singh in 1979, since the country had co-founded the movement. Modi's shift away from the legacy of Nehru is a significant departure from the traditional foreign policy approach of New Delhi and portends a move away from the practice, as well as the rhetoric of non-alignment.

Though a range of factors contributed to the development of non-alignment in India, three key factors can be identified to which the origins of non-alignment can be traced: nationalist inclinations, proximity to the Soviet Union, and economic troubles on the eve of independence. In the early 20th century, leaders of the Indian National Congress took